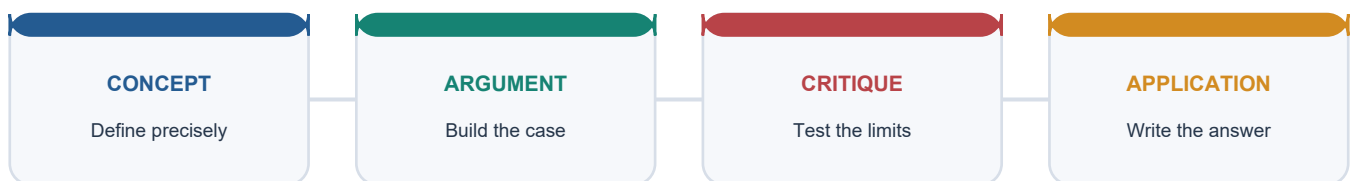


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Error Correction and Transformation - Qualifying English Learner-v2 Semantic Successor

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Error Correction and Transformation - Complete Qualifying English Learning Session

Identity: qualifying-english-05: learner-v2:g1 **Generation date:** 2026-09-06 **Approval:** false **Official syllabus anchor:** Usage and Vocabulary; integrated correction, active/passive voice, narration, meaning-preserving transformation and question tags.

Canonical/local source	SHA-256 at generation
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\basic\05_Error-Correction-and-Transformation.md	255750a81ae9876293ace84fb0f498eccf630655ad8f23257efca19d648ac0a5
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\00_Master-Framework.md	6d21958ce3d0da9107bd467ebfffb56f016d91a1ff5d873d3d2af31b1817d15
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md	80723c9ace35be70e1a38f623e6384269824ea68932a696ba97c6381690a9827
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\README.md	cb5fd830a1a1d8d346d37fde4f27ec00e901b478b37136772246abeaaf538a53
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\subject-wide-package\Qualifying-English_Practice-Solutions.md	9e04b1a14020cc7871448842f207b89d9c649293cab9fffd2ed7fb98118b7fb1

Verification references

- <https://upsc.gov.in/examinations/previous-question-papers>
- https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/grammar/subject_verb_agreement.html
- https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/punctuation/commas/index.html
- <https://dictionary.cambridge.org/grammar/british-grammar/collective-nouns>
- <https://www.merriam-webster.com/wordplay/singular-nonbinary-they>

The local official-paper evidence establishes recurring demands, not an official answer key. Public usage references were used to challenge absolutes and accepted-variation claims. The canonical repository owner remains the teaching source of truth.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Twelve-panel ASCII master flow

PANEL 01 - MEANING FIRST	
Establish the intended proposition before editing form.	
v	
PANEL 02 - FINITE-VERB SCAN	
Check completeness, agreement and tense before minor wording.	
v	
PANEL 03 - NOUN AND PRONOUN SCAN	
Check countability, determiners, case, reference and number.	
v	
PANEL 04 - PATTERN SCAN	
Check prepositions, phrasal verbs, word form, modifiers and parallelism.	
v	
PANEL 05 - MINIMAL REPAIR	
Change only the defective element and preserve acceptable wording.	
v	
PANEL 06 - VOICE ELIGIBILITY	
Confirm a suitable object before forming a passive.	
v	
PANEL 07 - VOICE MECHANICS	
Preserve tense, aspect, modal and necessary agent.	
v	
PANEL 08 - NARRATION PURPOSE	
Choose said, told, asked, requested, advised or ordered by function.	
v	
PANEL 09 - BACKSHIFT AND DEIXIS	
Change tense, pronouns, time and place only when context requires.	
v	
PANEL 10 - TRANSFORMATION CONDITIONS	
Apply no sooner, unless, too-to, despite and degree patterns only when meaning survives.	
v	
PANEL 11 - FOCUS AND TAGS	
Preserve only-scope and derive tags from polarity and auxiliary.	
v	
PANEL 12 - TIMED ERROR LOG	
Code the miss, state the rule, rewrite and retry a fresh item.	

Canonical Basic owner

Error Correction, Voice, Narration and Transformation - Core

1. Correction method and error codes

Read for meaning first, then scan in this order:

finite verb/agreement -> tense/conditional -> noun/determiner -> pronoun
-> verb pattern/preposition -> word form/spelling -> modifier/parallelism -> punctuation

Make the smallest change that restores standard formal English. Do not mark an accepted modern variant wrong merely because a traditional alternative exists.

Code	Check
AGR	agreement/number
CNT	countability/determiner
PRO	pronoun case, reference or agreement
TNS	tense/aspect
COND	conditional/polarity
ART	article/determiner
PREP	preposition or verb pattern
PHR	phrasal-verb position/meaning
MOD	misplaced/dangling modifier
PAR	parallel structure
PUNC	punctuation/capital
SPL	spelling/confusable
WF	word form
VAR	acceptable-variant issue

2. Frequent correction families

Fault	Safe correction
One of the applicant have...	<i>One of the applicants has...</i> [AGR/CNT]
furnitures/■informations	<i>furniture/information</i> or a measure phrase [CNT]
She is senior than me	<i>senior to me</i> [PREP]
He discussed about the proposal	<i>discussed the proposal</i> [PREP]
I have been waiting since three hours	<i>for three hours</i> [PREP]
When I will arrive...	<i>When I arrive...</i> [TNS]
comprises of	<i>comprises / consists of</i> [PREP]
look at children (care for)	<i>look after children</i> [PHR]
more wiser	<i>wiser</i> [WF]
The woodcutter was falling trees	<i>was felling trees</i> [WF]

The reason is because funding was delayed occurs in modern English, but some conservative examination keys reject it as redundant. To avoid a marking dispute, write *The reason is that funding was delayed* or *Funding was*

delayed because.... A key must not present the original as objectively ungrammatical without stating its house style [VAR].

3. Voice: preserve tense, object and meaning

Only a verb that has an object normally makes a passive. Move the object to subject position; keep tense, aspect, modal and relevant adverbials.

Active	Passive
<i>They write reports.</i>	<i>Reports are written.</i>
<i>They are writing a report.</i>	<i>A report is being written.</i>
<i>They wrote a report.</i>	<i>A report was written.</i>
<i>They had written a report.</i>	<i>A report had been written.</i>
<i>They have written a report.</i>	<i>A report has been written.</i>
<i>They will write a report.</i>	<i>A report will be written.</i>
<i>They can/must write a report.</i>	<i>A report can/must be written.</i>

Double objects, questions and imperatives

Active	Accepted passive(s)
<i>The board gave Riya a prize.</i>	<i>Riya was given a prize. / A prize was given to Riya.</i>
<i>Someone has sent me the file.</i>	<i>I have been sent the file. / The file has been sent to me.</i>
<i>Did the officer sign the order?</i>	<i>Was the order signed by the officer?</i>
<i>Who wrote the letter?</i>	<i>By whom was the letter written? (formal)</i>
<i>Open the door.</i>	<i>Let the door be opened. (formal, often unnatural)</i>
<i>Do not disturb the patient.</i>	<i>Let the patient not be disturbed.</i>

Omit by + agent when unknown, obvious or irrelevant: *The accused was arrested.* Do not force passive with intransitives (*arrive, occur, sleep*) or verbs that do not take the intended object. Prepositional passives are possible where the preposition belongs to the verb: *The proposal was approved of* is grammatical but often awkward; *The children were looked after* is natural.

4. Direct and indirect speech (narration)

First identify speaker, listener, reporting time and exact communicative purpose. Pronouns, time/place words and tense change only when the new context requires it.

Direct form	Indirect pattern
statement: <i>He said, "I am tired."</i>	<i>He said (that) he was tired.</i>
yes/no question: <i>She asked, "Are you ready?"</i>	<i>She asked whether/if I was ready.</i>
wh-question: <i>He asked, "Where do you live?"</i>	<i>He asked where I lived.</i>
command: <i>The officer said, "Close the door."</i>	<i>The officer ordered me to close the door.</i>
request: <i>She said to me, "Please wait."</i>	<i>She asked me to wait.</i>
negative command: <i>He said, "Do not move."</i>	<i>He told us not to move.</i>

In formal reported speech, a past reporting verb commonly backshifts: am/is -> was; are -> were; have/has done -> had done; did -> had done; will -> would; can -> could. Backshift is not automatic when the fact remains true, the report is immediate, or the writer deliberately keeps present relevance: *The teacher said that*

the Earth moves around the Sun. Universal truths normally remain present. Do not change a question into question word order: He asked where did I live -> *He asked where I lived.* Said to is usually replaced by a purpose verb (*asked, told, advised, ordered*) in commands.

5. Meaning-preserving transformations: conditions first

A transformation is correct only if time, polarity, emphasis, agent and scope remain the same. These are patterns, not automatic substitutions.

Original and condition	Safe transformation
<i>As soon as the bell rang, students left</i> (past)	<i>No sooner had the bell rung than the students left.</i>
past event immediately followed by another	<i>Hardly/Scarcely had the rain stopped when/before work resumed.</i>
if ... not with equivalent positive condition	<i>Unless you practise, you will not improve.</i>
<i>so + adjective + that + subject cannot/could not + verb</i>	<i>too + adjective + for + object + to + verb: The box is too heavy for me to lift.</i>
<i>although + clause</i>	<i>In spite of/despite + noun phrase or in spite of/despite the fact that + clause: Despite being tired, he worked.</i>
two positive parallel facts	<i>He is not only honest but also efficient.</i>
two negative qualities of same subject	<i>She is neither careless nor dishonest.</i>
purpose	<i>He worked hard so that he could qualify / in order to qualify</i> (same subject only)
comparative degree	<i>No other metal is as useful as iron -> Iron is the most useful metal</i> (only when the comparison set is unchanged)
only scope	<i>Only Meera checked the accounts -> Meera checked only the accounts</i> changes focus from actor to object; use only when that exact changed focus is requested.

Do not use an alleged *although* -> *however + adjective/adverb* formula. *However* is a conjunctive adverb and normally joins independent clauses: *The task was difficult; however, she completed it.* It cannot simply replace *although* at the start of a dependent clause.

Being + adjective/past participle must modify the grammatical subject: *Being flooded, the road was closed* is valid. *Being a holiday, the office was closed* dangles because an office is not a holiday. Use *As it was a holiday, the office was closed* or the formal absolute *It being a holiday, the office was closed.*

6. Question tags

Statement	Tag
<i>They will come</i>	<i>won't they?</i>
<i>She is not ready</i>	<i>is she?</i>
<i>I am late</i>	<i>aren't I?</i>
<i>Let's begin</i>	<i>shall we?</i>
<i>Open the door</i>	<i>will you?</i>
<i>Don't be late</i>	<i>will you?</i>
<i>There is a problem</i>	<i>isn't there?</i>

Use the auxiliary already present; use *do/does/did* when none appears.

7. Timed mixed diagnostic and retry gate

Attempt without notes in **15 minutes**:

1. Convert: *Someone has offered the students scholarships.*
2. Report: *The teacher said to Riya, "Please do not leave early."*
3. Report: *The guide said, "The Earth moves around the Sun."*
4. Transform without changing meaning: **Although the roads were flooded, the buses continued.**
5. Begin with *Unless*: *If you do not submit the form, you cannot sit the test.*
6. Correct: *Being a holiday, the office was closed.*
7. Correct: *No sooner the train arrived than we boarded it.*
8. Add a tag: *Let us revise the answer, ____?*
9. Correct: *The manager gave to Riya the file.*
10. Correct only if necessary: *Each candidate must bring their admit card.*

Key: 1 *The students have been offered scholarships / Scholarships have been offered to the students* [VOICE]; 2 *The teacher asked/told Riya not to leave early* [NAR]; 3 *The guide said that the Earth moves around the Sun* [NAR]; 4 *Despite/In spite of the flooded roads, the buses continued or Despite/In spite of the fact that the roads were flooded...* [TRN]; 5 *Unless you submit the form, you cannot sit the test* [COND]; 6 *As it was a holiday...* [MOD]; 7 *No sooner had the train arrived than...* [TNS]; 8 *shall we?* [TAG]; 9 *The manager gave Riya the file / gave the file to Riya* [VAR]; 10 no change required; singular *their* is accepted [VAR].

Retry gate: score at least **9/10**, with no COND, VOICE, NAR or VAR error. If not, log item number, code, wrong rule and corrected sentence; wait one day, then complete a fresh mixed set from the Foundation test. Do not move to full-paper practice until two consecutive timed attempts meet this gate.

Semantic-completeness closure - 2026-09-06

Literal syllabus, ownership and boundary

- **Syllabus demand:** Usage and Vocabulary; integrated correction, active/passive voice, narration, meaning-preserving transformation and question tags.
- **Canonical ownership:** Owns the ordered editing scan, error diagnosis, smallest valid correction, voice, direct/indirect speech, conditional and degree transformations, correlative structures and tags.
- **Cross-topic boundary:** Topics 01-04 own the underlying rules; Topic 05 integrates them in correction and transformation without duplicating full foundational teaching.

Complete learner and answer route

1. **Meaning first:** Establish the intended proposition before editing form.
2. **Finite-verb scan:** Check completeness, agreement and tense before minor wording.
3. **Noun and pronoun scan:** Check countability, determiners, case, reference and number.
4. **Pattern scan:** Check prepositions, phrasal verbs, word form, modifiers and parallelism.
5. **Minimal repair:** Change only the defective element and preserve acceptable wording.
6. **Voice eligibility:** Confirm a suitable object before forming a passive.
7. **Voice mechanics:** Preserve tense, aspect, modal and necessary agent.
8. **Narration purpose:** Choose said, told, asked, requested, advised or ordered by function.
9. **Backshift and deixis:** Change tense, pronouns, time and place only when context requires.
10. **Transformation conditions:** Apply no sooner, unless, too-to, despite and degree patterns only when meaning survives.
11. **Focus and tags:** Preserve only-scope and derive tags from polarity and auxiliary.
12. **Timed error log:** Code the miss, state the rule, rewrite and retry a fresh item.

Authority, variation and hostile-query gate

A transformation passes only if tense, polarity, agent, focus, scope and proposition remain equivalent. Accepted variants receive credit and conservative preferences are labelled as preferences.

The review checked the local official UPSC compulsory-English papers listed in README.md, the repository's verbatim syllabus, the subject-wide solved package, and standard public usage references recorded in the learner successor. It explicitly stress-tested: **smallest valid correction; active; passive voice; reported speech; backshift; transformation; scope; question tag.**

Prefer plain contemporary formal English. Where more than one standard form is legitimate, state the variation and select a conservative examination form only as a risk-control choice; do not falsely label the alternative ungrammatical.

Progressive practice and timed-paper transfer

1. Foundation: identify the demand and state the governing rule in plain language.
2. Controlled application: correct or construct one sentence and explain the change.
3. Passage/paragraph transfer: preserve meaning, reference, register and logical relation.
4. Hostile test: reject a close option that is grammatical in another meaning or variety.
5. Timed execution: answer, verify, classify the error, and retry a fresh item.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Diagnostic and core set

Q1. Foundation rule - minimal correction: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Make the smallest change that restores standard formal English and preserves meaning. B. Rewrite every acceptable sentence. C. Prefer the most elaborate alternative. D. Change both meaning and register.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q2. Foundation rule - error order: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Begin with rare spelling exceptions. B. Check finite verb and agreement before minor lexical polish. C. Ignore sentence meaning. D. Correct punctuation before locating clauses in every case.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q3. Foundation rule - accepted variation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every traditional preference is an absolute rule. B. Modern standard usage never counts. C. Label a legitimate variant instead of marking it wrong. D. Only one regional variety is English.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q4. Foundation rule - passive eligibility: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every intransitive verb can be passive. B. Happen has a direct object. C. Arrive normally forms was arrived. D. A transitive construction normally supplies the object promoted in a passive.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q5. Foundation rule - passive tense: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Preserve tense, aspect and modal when changing voice. B. Change past to present. C. Delete every modal. D. Add continuous aspect automatically.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q6. Foundation rule - double object: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the thing can become subject. B. Either recipient or thing may become subject where the verb permits both patterns. C. Delete the recipient. D. Insert an unrelated preposition.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q7. Foundation rule - reported question: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Retain did before the subject. B. Keep quotation marks. C. Use statement word order after asked whether/why/where. D. Use said that for every question.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q8. Foundation rule - backshift: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Backshift is mechanically compulsory. B. Never backshift. C. Universal truths must become past falsehoods. D. Backshift when the reporting context requires it; preserve continuing truths where appropriate.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q9. Foundation rule - no sooner: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use No sooner had + subject + participle + than for the past sequence. B. Use no sooner...when. C. Omit auxiliary inversion. D. Use simple present for any past pair.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q10. Foundation rule - unless: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Replace every if with unless. B. Use unless only where if...not preserves polarity and meaning. C. Use unless with an additional not automatically. D. Ignore the main-clause polarity.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q11. Foundation rule - only scope: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only never changes meaning by position. B. Place only sentence-finally in every case. C. Place only beside the element it limits. D. Delete the focused element.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q12. Foundation rule - question tags: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use isn't it for every sentence. B. Repeat the statement polarity. C. Use will we after let's. D. Match the auxiliary and reverse polarity; use shall we after let's.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q13. Editing decision - minimal correction: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Make the smallest change that restores standard formal English and preserves meaning. B. Rewrite every acceptable sentence. C. Prefer the most elaborate alternative. D. Change both meaning and register.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q14. Editing decision - error order: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Begin with rare spelling exceptions. B. Check finite verb and agreement before minor lexical polish. C. Ignore sentence meaning. D. Correct punctuation before locating clauses in every case.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q15. Editing decision - accepted variation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every traditional preference is an absolute rule. B. Modern standard usage never counts. C. Label a legitimate variant instead of marking it wrong. D. Only one regional variety is English.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q16. Editing decision - passive eligibility: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every intransitive verb can be passive. B. Happen has a direct object. C. Arrive normally forms was arrived. D. A transitive construction normally supplies the object promoted in a passive.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Progressive transfer exercises with model answers

Transfer 1. Correct minimally: "One of the applicant have withdrawn."

Model answer: One of the applicants has withdrawn.

Transfer 2. Change voice: "The board gave Riya a prize."

Model answer: Riya was given a prize by the board / A prize was given to Riya by the board.

Transfer 3. Explain why "The meeting was arrived at noon" is invalid.

Model answer: Arrive is intransitive here; there is no object to promote.

Transfer 4. Report: "She asked, 'Are you ready?'"

Model answer: She asked whether/if I was ready.

Transfer 5. Report the continuing truth: "The guide said, 'The Earth moves around the Sun.'"

Model answer: The guide said that the Earth moves around the Sun.

Transfer 6. Transform: "As soon as the bell rang, the students left."

Model answer: No sooner had the bell rung than the students left.

Transfer 7. Transform with unless: "If you do not verify the source, you may spread an error."

Model answer: Unless you verify the source, you may spread an error.

Transfer 8. Add a tag: "Let us begin, ?"

Model answer: shall we?

Remediation protocol

1. State the rule or passage evidence before looking at the options.
2. Explain why each close distractor fails in this context.
3. Record accepted variation separately from genuine error.
4. Rewrite one fresh sentence or paragraph using the same principle.
5. Advance only after two consecutive correct timed attempts.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified local official-paper demand ledger

Year	Local official paper	Demand routed to this topic	Provenance status
2018	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMP-00.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2019	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-EnglishCompulsory.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2020	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH (1).pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2021	books\more_previous_papers\English.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2022	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-ENGLISH-Comp1-280922.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2023	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-290923.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2025	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-QP-CSM-25-010925.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required

This table records verified paper demand and format only. It does not reproduce copyrighted question wording, invent a UPSC key, or claim that UPSC publishes model answers.

Timed hostile set

Q33. Timed-paper choice - no sooner: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use No sooner had + subject + participle + than for the past sequence. B. Use no sooner...when. C. Omit auxiliary inversion. D. Use simple present for any past pair.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q34. Timed-paper choice - unless: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Replace every if with unless. B. Use unless only where if...not preserves polarity and meaning. C. Use unless with an additional not automatically. D. Ignore the main-clause polarity.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q35. Timed-paper choice - only scope: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only never changes meaning by position. B. Place only sentence-finally in every case. C. Place only beside the element it limits. D. Delete the focused element.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q36. Timed-paper choice - question tags: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use isn't it for every sentence. B. Repeat the statement polarity. C. Use will we after let's. D. Match the auxiliary and reverse polarity; use shall we after let's.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q37. Hostile variation check - minimal correction: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Make the smallest change that restores standard formal English and preserves meaning. B. Rewrite every acceptable sentence. C. Prefer the most elaborate alternative. D. Change both meaning and register.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q38. Hostile variation check - error order: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Begin with rare spelling exceptions. B. Check finite verb and agreement before minor lexical polish. C. Ignore sentence meaning. D. Correct punctuation before locating clauses in every case.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q39. Hostile variation check - accepted variation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every traditional preference is an absolute rule. B. Modern standard usage never counts. C. Label a legitimate variant instead of marking it wrong. D. Only one regional variety is English.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q40. Hostile variation check - passive eligibility: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every intransitive verb can be passive. B. Happen has a direct object. C. Arrive normally forms was arrived. D. A transitive construction normally supplies the object promoted in a passive.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Register-sensitive refinements

- Passive voice is not inherently inferior; use it when the receiver, process or unknown agent is the discourse focus.
- Backshift is context-sensitive. Universal truths and deliberately current facts may remain in the present.
- *The reason is because* is widespread modern usage, but *The reason is that* avoids a conservative marking dispute.
- Imperative passives such as *Let the door be opened* are grammatical but often stylistically unnatural.

Adversarial checks

Test double-object passives, prepositional passives, wh-question order in reported speech, modal perfects, dangling *being* clauses, unless polarity, no-sooner inversion, comparison-set preservation and shifts in *only* focus.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Rapid reconstruction spine

- **Meaning first:** Establish the intended proposition before editing form.
- **Finite-verb scan:** Check completeness, agreement and tense before minor wording.
- **Noun and pronoun scan:** Check countability, determiners, case, reference and number.
- **Pattern scan:** Check prepositions, phrasal verbs, word form, modifiers and parallelism.
- **Minimal repair:** Change only the defective element and preserve acceptable wording.
- **Voice eligibility:** Confirm a suitable object before forming a passive.
- **Voice mechanics:** Preserve tense, aspect, modal and necessary agent.
- **Narration purpose:** Choose said, told, asked, requested, advised or ordered by function.
- **Backshift and deixis:** Change tense, pronouns, time and place only when context requires.
- **Transformation conditions:** Apply no sooner, unless, too-to, despite and degree patterns only when meaning survives.
- **Focus and tags:** Preserve only-scope and derive tags from polarity and auxiliary.
- **Timed error log:** Code the miss, state the rule, rewrite and retry a fresh item.

Ownership, variation and answer firewall

- **Own here:** Owns the ordered editing scan, error diagnosis, smallest valid correction, voice, direct/indirect speech, conditional and degree transformations, correlative structures and tags.
- **Route elsewhere:** Topics 01-04 own the underlying rules; Topic 05 integrates them in correction and transformation without duplicating full foundational teaching.
- **Verification rule:** A transformation passes only if tense, polarity, agent, focus, scope and proposition remain equivalent. Accepted variants receive credit and conservative preferences are labelled as preferences.
- Prefer the smallest defensible correction; preserve meaning and label accepted variants.
- In passage work, cite the text. In precis, add nothing. In essays, invent no quotation or statistic.

Timed-paper spine

READ DEMAND -> MAP STRUCTURE -> APPLY RULE -> CHECK MEANING -> FLAG VARIATION -> REVISE